

HEMA SHAH

Email: hshah@ftc.gov ♦ Website: www.hema-shah-econ.com

Citizenship: U.S.A.

EMPLOYMENT

Economist, Federal Trade Commission

2026-Present

EDUCATION

Duke University

2026

Ph.D., Economics

Dissertation Committee: Peter Arcidiacono (chair), Jason Baron, Lisa Gennetian, Arnaud Maurel, Pengpeng Xiao

University of Virginia

2020

B.A. with Highest Distinction, Mathematics and Economics

GPA: 3.925

Echols Scholar, College Science Scholar

RESEARCH FIELDS

Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Public Economics, Applied Microeconometrics

WORKING PAPERS

** first author. † non-first author. All other authorship is alphabetical.*

High School Teachers and College-Relevant Skill Production: Evidence from ACT Score Value Added
Job Market Paper.

Income Support, Marriage, and Family Stability*

(with Lisa A. Gennetian, Katherine Magnuson, and Kimberly G. Noble)

Money or Time? Heterogeneous Effects of Unconditional Cash on Parental Investments*

(with Lisa A. Gennetian, Katherine Magnuson, Hirokazu Yoshikawa, Laura Stilwell, Kimberly G. Noble, and Greg J. Duncan)

NBER Working Paper w33737.

The Impact of Monthly Unconditional Cash on Food Security, Spending, and Consumption Among Families with Low Income and Young Children†

(with Lisa A. Gennetian, Matthew Maury, Laura Stilwell, Katherine Magnuson, Kimberly G. Noble, Greg J. Duncan, Nathan Fox, Sarah Halpern-Meekin, and Hirokazu Yoshikawa)

SSRN Working Paper 4781670.

Class Rank and Student Disability Classification

(with Marie Hull and Maria Zhu)

PUBLICATIONS

Shah, Hema. 2026. College Admissions Testing and Learning about Ability: Evidence from Strategic ACT and SAT Taking. **Economics of Education Review**, 112, 102797.

Shah, Hema* & Lisa A. Gennetian. 2024. Unconditional Cash Transfers for Families with Children in the U.S.: A Scoping Review. **Review of Economics of the Household**, 22(2), 415-450.

NBER Working Paper w30965.

Shah, Hema. 2020. A Glass Escalator for Female UVA Graduates? Gender Gaps Across the Starting Salary Distribution. **Atlantic Economic Journal**, 48(4), 539-541.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Course Withdrawals and the Path to College Dropout (with Tom Ahn and Peter Arcidiacono)

POLICY WRITING

Gennetian, Lisa A., **Hema Shah**,[†] Luis E. Basurto, Laura Stilwell, Hirokazu Yoshikawa, Silvana Freire, Katherine Magnuson, Kimberly G. Noble, Greg J. Duncan, Nathan A. Fox, & Sarah Halpern-Meekin. (2025). *Effects of Monthly Unconditional Cash Starting at Birth Among Latina Families with Low Income*. National Center for Research on Hispanic Children & Families.

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant

Peter Arcidiacono (Duke University) 2021-Present

Lisa Gennetian (Duke University), *Baby's First Years Project* 2022-Present

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Sarah Turner (University of Virginia) 2020

Sandip Sukhtankar (University of Virginia) 2018-2019

Summer Analyst

Cornerstone Research, Washington, DC 2019

TEACHING

Invited Guest Lecturer

ECON 204: Econometrics and Data Science Summer 2025

Instructor: Julie Bennett (Duke University)

ECON 490: Economics of Gender and Family Spring 2025

Instructor: Pengpeng Xiao (Duke University)

ECON 4070: Gender and Economics Spring 2024

Instructor: Amalia Miller (University of Virginia)

Graduate Teaching Assistant

ECON 707: PhD Econometrics II Spring 2022

Instructors: Adam Rosen and Andrew Patton (Duke University)

ECON 703: PhD Econometrics I Fall 2021

Instructor: Matt Masten (Duke University)

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

ECON 3559: Economics, Sustainability, and the Environment Fall 2019

Instructor: William Shobe (University of Virginia)

STAT 2120: Introduction to Statistical Analysis Spring 2018

Instructor: Jeffrey Woo (University of Virginia)

PRESENTATIONS

2026: University of South Florida, Federal Trade Commission, National Tax Association Spring Symposium

2025: Atlanta Workshop on Public Policy and Child Well-Being, Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Meeting (poster session), Duke Economics Labor/Public Lunch, Triangle Applied Microeconomics Conference, Triangle Economics of Education Workshop, Duke Sanford Graduate Research Workshop, Demography Daze, UNC Greensboro Brown Bag, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Meeting, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

2023: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Meeting, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

2020: International Atlantic Economic Society (Virtual)

HONORS AND AWARDS

Program for Advanced Research in the Social Sciences (PARISS) Fellowship <i>Duke University Social Science Research Institute</i> <i>Interdisciplinary fellowship awarding full funding to one economics PhD student each academic year</i>	2023-2024
Finalist, Best Undergraduate Paper Contest <i>International Atlantic Economic Society</i>	2020
Best Distinguished Majors Thesis Award <i>University of Virginia Department of Economics</i>	2020

SERVICE

Referee Service <i>Economics Bulletin, Review of Economics of the Household, Child Abuse & Neglect, Southern Economic Journal</i>	
Co-Organizer, Duke Economics Student Labor/Public Workshop <i>Duke University</i>	2023-2024
Co-Chair, Duke Graduate Mentorship Program <i>Duke University</i>	2023-2024
Mentor, Duke Graduate Mentorship Program <i>Duke University</i>	2022-2024
Co-Chair, Economics Graduate Student Council <i>Duke University</i>	2021-2023
Graduate Student Liason, Duke Graduate School <i>Duke University</i>	2021-2026
Member, Echols Scholars Program Advisory Committee <i>University of Virginia</i>	2020-Present

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Stata, R, MATLAB, L^AT_EX